

Dear Thumbtack hiring team,

I'm applying for the Senior Data Scientist role on your Business Analytics team. Your post wants someone leadership can hand a hard question to and trust the number that comes back. That's been my job for two years, and it's the part of the work I like best.

For two years I was the sole data strategist at Pharmacists Mutual, reporting straight to company leadership. I rebuilt our enterprise analytical reporting from scratch: SQL Server, SSIS, Tabular models, Power BI, the works. I replaced legacy vendor logic with documented systems I could actually walk a room through, and cut storage 50% and processing time over 60% along the way.

I got promoted to Lead Data Engineer in March 2026 and now run the team behind that reporting. I pushed Claude Code adoption across the org and wrote the security framework that got it cleared for prod, which cut our Agile story delivery time roughly in half. I also led the evaluation that picked our MDM platform, and I own hiring and onboarding now, so I've seen firsthand what it costs to grow a data team without just throwing headcount at it.

Insurance analytics isn't glamorous, I'll admit, but it's where I learned to build reporting people actually bet decisions on. I'm ready for a bigger audience.

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen